

Animal Life (Part - 3)

Birds:

Animals, which live mostly in air and have feathers and wings are called as Birds. All birds have wings but not all birds can fly. Millions of year ago some birds went back to sea and their feathers are adapted according to water to help them in swimming.

More than 9,000 kinds of birds are present today. The size of birds varies from the largest African ostrich (taller than and man) to the smallest humming bird of 3 - 4 cm length.

Look at the parts of body of a bird in the following picture:

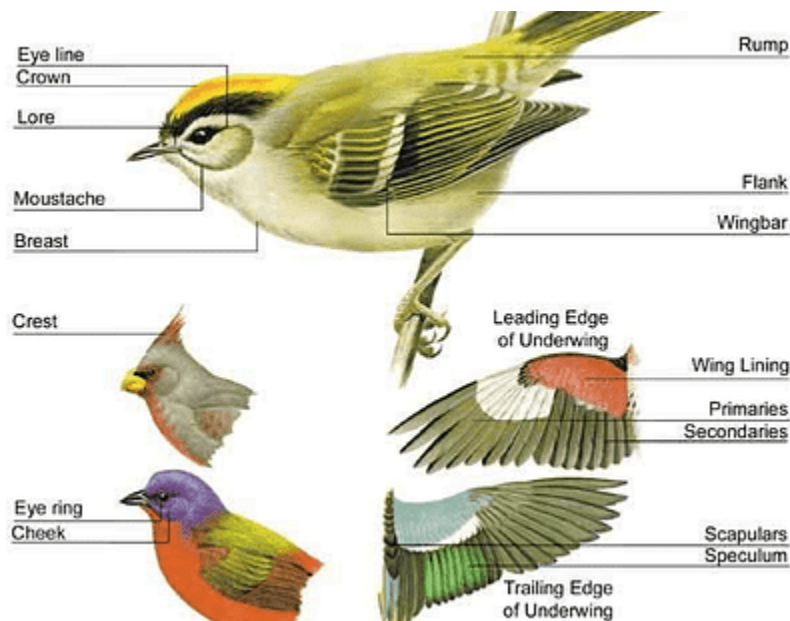


Fig: Different parts of Bird

General Features of Birds:

- They have light and hollow strong bones and skull.
- Birds have hard beak or bill instead of teeth or mouth.
- They are not very big in size, except few.
- They have wings covered with feathers, instead of hand.
- Tail of bird is made up of feathers.
- They have boat shaped body to fly easily in air.
- Birds have strong flight muscles to move the wings up and down.
- They are warm blooded.

- The tail of a bird acts like the rudder of a boat to change the direction during flight.
- Respiratory system well developed to breathe at high altitudes where air is thinner.
- When wings of bird move upwards called upstroke movement. When wings move downwards called down stroke movement.
- There are more than 9,000 species of birds.

Look at the following table of types of birds:

Flightless Birds	Water birds	Walking flying at low height
Kiwi	Ducks	Hen
Ostrich	Swan	Peacock
Penguin	Gulls	
	Pelicans	
	Albatross	

Birds flying at great heights	Birds flying at heights
Eagles	Sparrow
Vultures	

Distinct features of few birds :

S. No.	Name of Birds	Special features
1.	Albatross	Live in water, webbed feet that help to swim, water proof feathers because of oil glands. Largest flying bird with largest wing span.
2.	Ducks	Same features as above. It has flat and broad beak to dig up the mud present under water. It has
3.	Parrot	strainers to facilitate removal of mud and water leaving behind tiny animals in the mouth, not found
4.	Flamingo	in Antarctica. Produces quacking sound. Live in warm and tropical areas, can mimic human
5.	Kiwi	speech. It has hooked beak to crack nuts and hard fruits and helpful in climbing also.
6.	Ostrich	Live near lagoons. Pink in color, long neck and legs.
		Flightless bird. It is national symbol of New

7.	Peacock	Zealand. Long beak and plumb body. Move with the help of legs. it's an endangered species
8.	Eagle, vulture, kite, hawks	Large flightless bird. It has long neck and legs. Its speed is very fast- Its egg is largest of all the eggs.
9.	Woodpecker	Large colorful bird. Its females is called peahen. Its tail feathers are beautiful and attractive. It has short, hard and horny beak to eat nuts, grains and seeds,
10.	Kingfisher	Carnivorous, have strong, sharp and hooked beaks to tear the flesh.
11.	Penguin	Chisel shaped strong and heavy beaks to make tides in the trunk. Broad, long and pointed beak to catch fish from the river etc. Aquatic flightless birds. Found in Antarctica upright wedding gait. Wings modified into flippers, allowing them to swim fast in water.

Bald Eagle and wandering albatross birds



Bald eagle makes the biggest nest in birds



Wandering albatross has the longest wings

Feeding in Birds

Birds eat nuts, fruits, grains, etc. Few birds are carnivorous and eat other animals such as, eagle, vulture, hawk and owls. Owl is found in farmland and has light face with black eyes.



Fig: Owl

Owl has very big front eyes with very good hearing sense

Owl generally catches its prey in the darkness- Its prey includes other birds even the babies of eagles and hawk. Vultures are scavenger and feed on animals that are already dead.

Migration in Birds (Adaptation to Weather)

Some birds leave their homes during winter to find food in warmer places. This is called migration. The arctic tern breeds during summer and then travels a distance of 17,000 km to the Antarctic in the south. It again goes back to the same place to breed.

Siberian crane migrate to India (Bharatput birds sanctuary and other) during winter, it goes back to Siberia in summer.



Siberian crane migrating towards india

Nest

Birds lay eggs in nests on the trees, roof of the houses, holes in the ground and along

river banks.



Weaver birds makes complicated nest by knotting strips of leaves together



Pigeon makes nest with small twigs and branches



Hoopoe makes hole in a tree to keep its eggs safe from the predators

Commonly Asked Questions

1. Webbed feet and water proof feathers are the features of which one of the following types of birds?

- (a) Flightless birds
- (b) Water birds
- (c) Walking birds
- (d) Birds flying at height
- (e) None of these

Answer: (b)

Explanation

Water birds have webbed feet to make them swim faster. Water proof feathers are

adaptation to live in water. Therefore, option (B) is correct and rest of the options is incorrect.

2. Ayush is the only child of his parents, he finds himself alone at home because his parents are working. He was advised to keep bird as a pet in his house but he was confused as which birds he should purchase? Which bird you would suggest for him?

- (a) Albatross
- (b) Flamingo
- (c) Parakeet
- (d) Penguin
- (e) Sunbird

Answer: (c)

Explanation

Parakeet is a small parrot and popular pet. It can mimic human speech and form sentences and it can be a good friend in his spare time.

Therefore, option (C) is correct and rest of the options is incorrect.